

Discussion of “Fertility: the impact of social norms and stigma after forced migration”

Battiston et al.

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Kırdar and Oruç, 2026	This paper
Syrian inflow → Turkish natives	Turkish norms → Syrian migrants
Realized parity progression	Beliefs, ideals, intentions
Higher-parity fertility ↑	Desired fertility / intentions ↓
Strong: Arabic/Kurdish, low-edu, border	Strong: men, religious respondents
Labor-market / opportunity-cost channel	Information / stigma / norm channel

Suggests a two-sided convergence process, though not through a single symmetric mechanism.

How much convergence has already happened?

The paper controls for months in Turkey, which is sensible. Heterogeneity by months already in Turkey could be interesting.

Belief about Turkish couples	Control belief	Truth	Gap
Actual n. of children	2.3	2.0	+0.3
Ideal n. of children	3.3	2.8	+0.5

After ~ 8 years in Turkey on average (Table 2; sample-mean months in Türkiye ≈ 93), controls still **overestimate** Turkish fertility. Everyday contact closes the gap *slowly*.

Is the treatment effect larger for migrants who arrived more recently, whose beliefs are still further from the Turkish baseline?

- Recent arrivals: beliefs still far from the Turkish baseline. Lots of room to move.
- Long-resident migrants: beliefs already closer to natives. Less room to move.

Syrian Information Treatment as Placebo?

Both treatments deliver **real informational updates**: subjects also misperceive Syrian fertility. The Syrian Information Treatment is framed as a priming control. It also moves some outcomes, on a narrower set of margins than the Turkish treatment.

	Turkish treatment <i>host-society norm</i>	Syrian treatment <i>in-group migrant norm</i>
Ideal <i>n</i> for self	↓	↓ (smaller)
Perceived stigma	↑	↑ (smaller)
Fertility intentions	↓ strong	≈ 0

Read this way, the Syrian Information Treatment is not a placebo but in-group norm information. Only host-society information shifts intentions strongly. In-group information shifts ideals and stigma but not intentions.

	Exposure <i>learning channel</i>	Authority <i>intra-household channel</i>
Why men respond	more contact with natives via work, language, friends	more weight on husband's preferences in the joint decision
Why religious respond	more public/social life, hence more native exposure	even more weight on husband's preferences; wife's update muted in joint outcome

Spouses may update equally, but religious couples translate the *husband's* updated belief into the joint outcome more fully.

Only one respondent per couple: if the wife updates but has no voice in the decision, we cannot see her update in the data. Interacting treatment with Turkish language, friends, employment, and mixed-neighborhood residence would show how much goes through exposure.